

# Letter Before Claim

**Date:** 16 May 2026

**To:**

Tom Tenant  
2 High Street London  
E1 2BB

**From:**

Alice Landlord  
1 High Street London  
E1 1AA

## LETTER OF CLAIM - UNPAID RENT AND ARREARS

Dear Tom Tenant,

### Re: Property at 2 High Street London

I am writing to you about the money I say you owe in connection with the above property. This letter is sent in accordance with the **Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims**. It sets out:

- the amount claimed;
- what the debt is said to cover;
- how the figure has been calculated;
- what you can do next; and
- what may happen if you do not reply or pay.

### 1. Summary of the Debt

|                                         |                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Rent arrears:</b>                    | £2430.00        |
| <b>Property damage / other costs:</b>   | £380.00         |
| <b>Other charges:</b>                   | £80.00          |
| <b>Interest to date (8% per annum):</b> | £64.89          |
| <b>TOTAL AMOUNT OWED:</b>               | <b>£2954.89</b> |

*Interest continues to accrue at £0.63 per day until the debt is paid in full.*

## 2. Breakdown of the Debt

### Rent Arrears

You occupy the property under an assured shorthold tenancy that commenced on 1 January 2024. The agreed rent is £950.00 monthly, payable in advance.

You have failed to pay rent as it fell due. The arrears have accumulated over multiple rent periods. A detailed schedule showing each period, the amount due, what you paid, and the balance is attached as **Appendix 1**.

### Property Damage and Other Costs

In addition to rent arrears, you are liable for the following:

- Broken internal door - £200.00
- Professional clean due to excessive staining - £180.00

### Other Recoverable Charges

- Locksmith call-out - £80.00

### Interest

I am entitled to claim interest on the outstanding rent and costs pursuant to **section 69 of the County Courts Act 1984**. Interest is calculated at 8% per annum from 2 February 2026 and continues to accrue at £0.63 per day until payment.

The interest calculation to 16 May 2026 is £64.89. The full working is attached as **Appendix 2**.

## 3. What You Must Do Now

You have **30 days from the date of this letter** (i.e., until 15 June 2026) to do ONE of the following:

1. **Pay the full amount owed** (£2954.89) to avoid court proceedings.
2. **Contact me to discuss a payment arrangement** if you cannot pay in full.
3. **Complete the enclosed Reply Form** if you dispute the debt or need time to seek advice.

### Payment Methods

If you wish to pay the debt in full, please arrange payment by bank transfer using the details below.

- Account name: Alice Landlord
- Sort code: 10-20-30
- Account number: 12345678
- Payment reference: E1 2BB arrears

If you need to discuss payment, use the contact details shown at the top of this letter.

### Payment Plans

If you cannot pay the full amount but can make regular payments, I may be willing to consider a payment arrangement. You must contact me within 30 days with a realistic proposal. Any offer must:

- Clear the arrears within a reasonable time (typically 6-12 months);

- Include ongoing rent payments in full;
- Be supported by evidence of your income and expenditure.

Please complete the enclosed **Financial Statement Form** if you wish to propose a payment plan.

#### 4. Sources of Free Debt Advice

If you are unsure what to do, you can get free, independent debt advice from:

- **Citizens Advice:** 0800 144 8848 or [www.citizensadvice.org.uk](http://www.citizensadvice.org.uk)
- **StepChange Debt Charity:** 0800 138 1111 or [www.stepchange.org](http://www.stepchange.org)
- **National Debtline:** 0808 808 4000 or [www.nationaldebtline.org](http://www.nationaldebtline.org)
- **MoneyHelper:** 0800 138 7777 or [www.moneyhelper.org.uk](http://www.moneyhelper.org.uk)

*These services are free and confidential. They can help you understand your options and, if needed, contact me on your behalf.*

#### 5. What Happens If You Do Not Respond or Pay

If you do not respond to this letter within 30 days, or if you do not make acceptable arrangements to pay, I will have no choice but to issue court proceedings against you without further warning.

**If I issue a court claim, I will ask the court for:**

- the full amount owed (£2954.89) together with **court fees and any recoverable costs**;
- the court fee, which is currently about £205.00;
- continuing interest at £0.63 per day until payment or judgment;
- a County Court Judgment, which can affect your credit record for six years if it is not paid in time; and
- enforcement action if needed, such as bailiffs, an attachment of earnings order, or a charging order.

**It is in your best interests to contact me now to resolve this matter.**

#### 6. Documents Enclosed

The following documents are enclosed with this letter:

1. Information Sheet for Defendants
2. Reply Form
3. Financial Statement Form
4. Appendix 1: Schedule of Rent Arrears
5. Appendix 2: Interest Calculation

#### 7. Your Rights

You have the right to:

- Seek free debt advice from the organisations listed above;
- Dispute the debt if you believe it is wrong;

- Ask for more information or documents;
- Propose a payment plan if you cannot pay in full;
- Defend any court claim if you have a valid legal defence.

**Please do not ignore this letter.** If you need time, documents, or debt advice, use the Reply Form and let me know within 30 days.

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Yours sincerely,

Alice Landlord

Date: 16 April 2026

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**IMPORTANT:** *This is a formal Letter Before Claim sent under the Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims. You should reply within 30 days. If you do not reply or pay, court proceedings may be started without further notice.*